

The term that actually drives people up the wall, however, is 'Syndication'. Web Syndication is often confused with copyright. Though in some cases, syndication does involve procuring a license from the originator of the story, in many cases these days, syndication on the Web merely means making feeds available from a site so other people can display an updating list of content from it. This originated with news and blog sites, but is increasingly used to syndicate any information.

So how does this update happen? And how does it benefit the end-user? For someone to subscribe to an RSS feed, a few conditions are a must:

First and foremost, the publisher of the content must make the content available in the RSS format. Secondly, the person subscribing to a feed must have a feed reader or 'News Aggregator'. This gets us to the whole point of this article. What in the name of Brin and Page is a news aggregator?

The Boss

Simply put, a really smooth set of code that fits snugly into your Internet browser or desktop is an aggregator. But what exactly does this software do?

In a nutshell, a News Aggregator periodically downloads the latest headlines from your chosen news sources and displays them in one convenient place. It enables you to glance at the latest headlines and gives you the ability to read the full story behind those headlines that interest you. You don't have to go scouring around the Internet nor does your bookmarks list have to flow into hundreds to get the news that interests you!

News feed readers come as individual software that can be downloaded off the Internet. You also have RSS readers that can be added as extensions to your browser (Only Firefox and Opera as yet) or sites such as Bloglines (registration required) that let you check all your feeds from any Web browser.

So no more unwanted tabs open on your Firefox or Opera, no more waiting for the advertisements to load for just a quick glance through the headlines. What aggregators (and RSS and Atom as a whole) have done is given you the choice to read only the news you want to read. You get to run a quick check on the headlines and pick only the ones that really interest you. What you can also do, is choose the sites or blogs you want to subscribe to. This is truly having your cake and eating it too!

Best Practice Guidelines For AdSense

Syndicate the full text of your articles

The more content that is available in a site's feed, the better the user experience, and the more likely people are to subscribe your feed. If you can't put the full text of your articles in your feed, then in addition to the headline of each article, include as informative a snippet as possible of the article's text.

Don't include more than one ad unit per article

Feeds represent an uncluttered, highly targeted medium, and these characteristics should be preserved to maintain and grow an audience. The AdSense for feeds ad format has been designed to be very streamlined to ensure that users are not overwhelmed with advertising.

Place the ad unit at the end of articles

The content of an article is what users are most interested in, and that should be placed first. Then they can read the ad with more context.

Include terms and conditions on the use of your feeds

Just as you have rights associated with the original content you create on your Web site, you also have rights associated with your feed content. If you have concerns about those rights, specify the exact terms and conditions for the use of your feeds somewhere on your site.

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